Retail Sales Performance Analysis

Objective and method

This report reviews 150 simulated transaction records to identify sales patterns by product category, region and month. Net sales are calculated as quantity × unit price, less the recorded discount. The estimated cost is assumed to equal 65% of gross sales; estimated profit is net sales minus this assumed cost. The dataset is fictional and does not represent an actual company.

Total net sales	Estimated profit	Orders	Units sold	Average net sales
R 110,399.75	R 35,334.63	150	1,001	R 736.00

Key findings

Highest-selling category- Electronics: Net sales were R 51,804.83, approximately 46.9% of total net sales. This makes Electronics the largest category by sales value in this dataset. Sales value alone does not establish which category is most profitable or whether demand is being fully met.

Lowest-selling region- Cape Town: Cape Town generated R 21,549.67 in net sales across 31 orders, the lowest regional total. This may reflect fewer orders, smaller baskets, product mix or other factors; the data does not establish the cause.

Monthly variation: Net sales peaked in May at R 15,769.78 and were lowest in Sep at R 4,226.92. Sales varied substantially across the year. The simulated dataset can highlight months to investigate, but it cannot explain the variation without context such as promotions, seasonality, stock availability or marketing activity.

Three evidence-based recommendations

1. **Investigate Electronics performance**. Electronics contributed 46.9% of net sales, the largest category share. Review item-level sales, estimated margin, stockouts, returns and supplier lead times before deciding whether to expand stock or adjust promotions. Compare unit volumes and profit, not sales value alone.

2**. Diagnose the Cape Town sales gap**. Cape Town had the lowest regional net sales (R 21,549.67; 31 orders). Compare average order value, product availability, channel mix, customer traffic and marketing activity with higher-performing regions. Test targeted actions only after identifying a plausible cause.

3. **Review monthly peaks and dips**. Investigate the high-sales month (May) and low-sales month (Sep) against promotions, holidays, stock

availability and order volumes. Add more periods of real data before drawing conclusions about seasonality, then use the findings to plan inventory and staffing.

Dashboard Snapshot

